Start a web page

Digital Technologies · School and personal computers

You will

- make `index.html` and `style.css`
- use shortcuts that write code for you
- preview your page with **Go Live**

You need

- VS Code with your project folder open and trusted (see the guide Open a project folder in VS Code)
- Live Server installed (see the guide Install VS Code extensions)

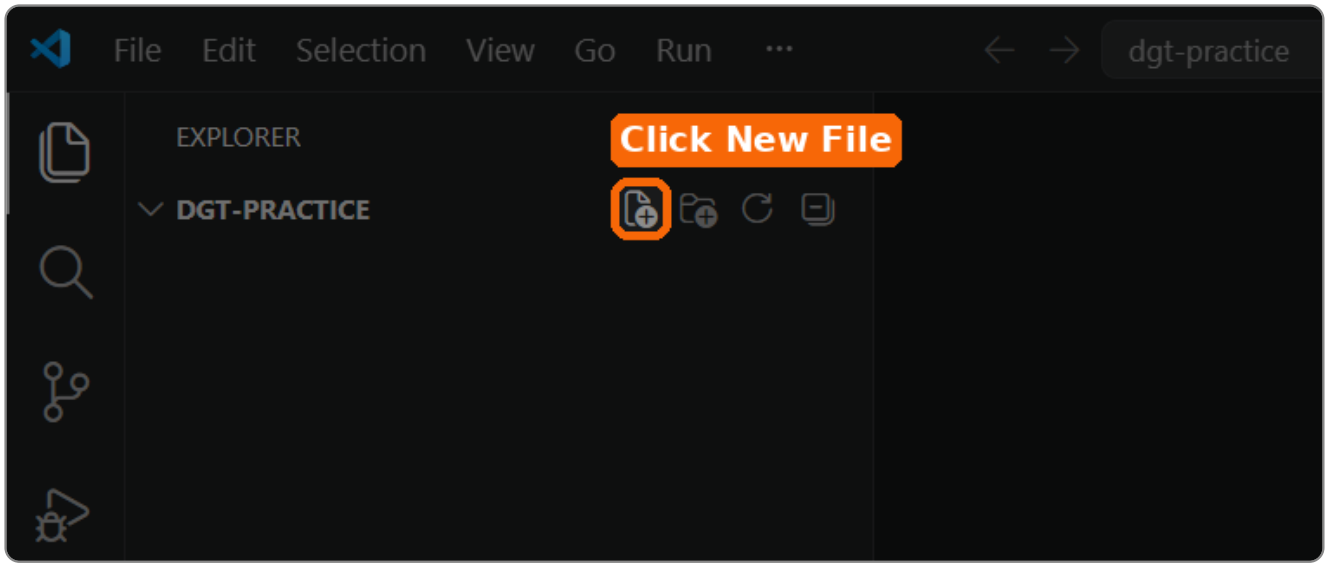
 Click here  Look here

1

VS Code › Explorer

Point at your folder name.

Click the **New File...** icon.



2

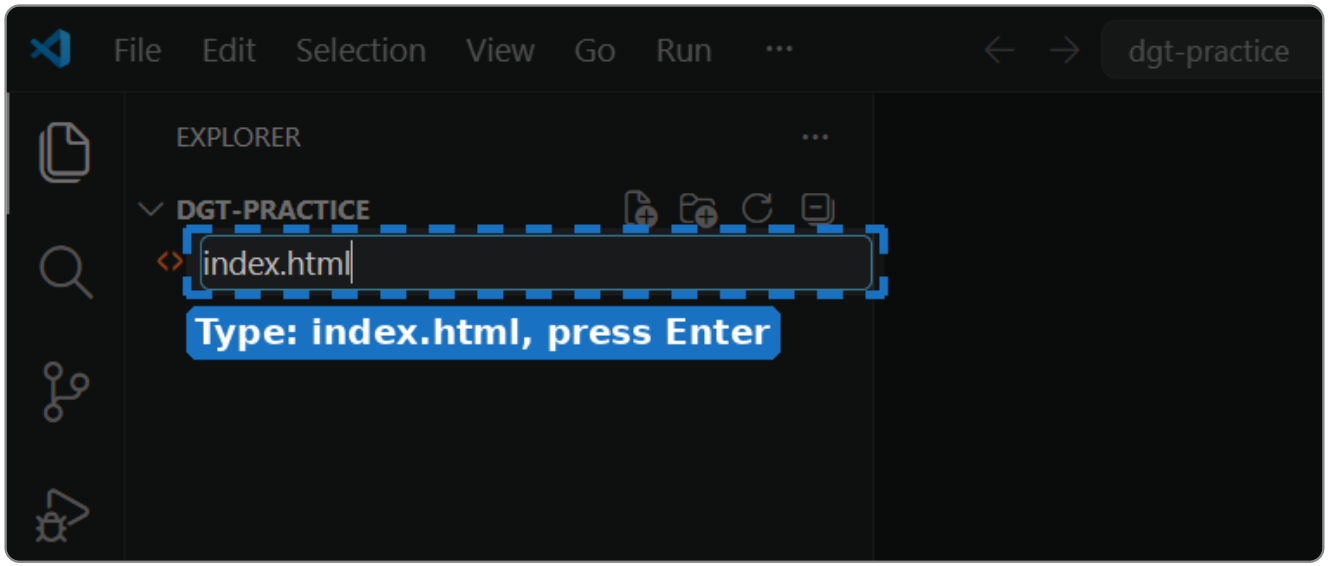
VS Code › Explorer

Type `index.html`.

Press `Enter`.

Use exactly this name, in lowercase. Browsers look for index.html first.

> **Check:** `index.html` opens. The grey writing in it is only a hint: you can ignore it.



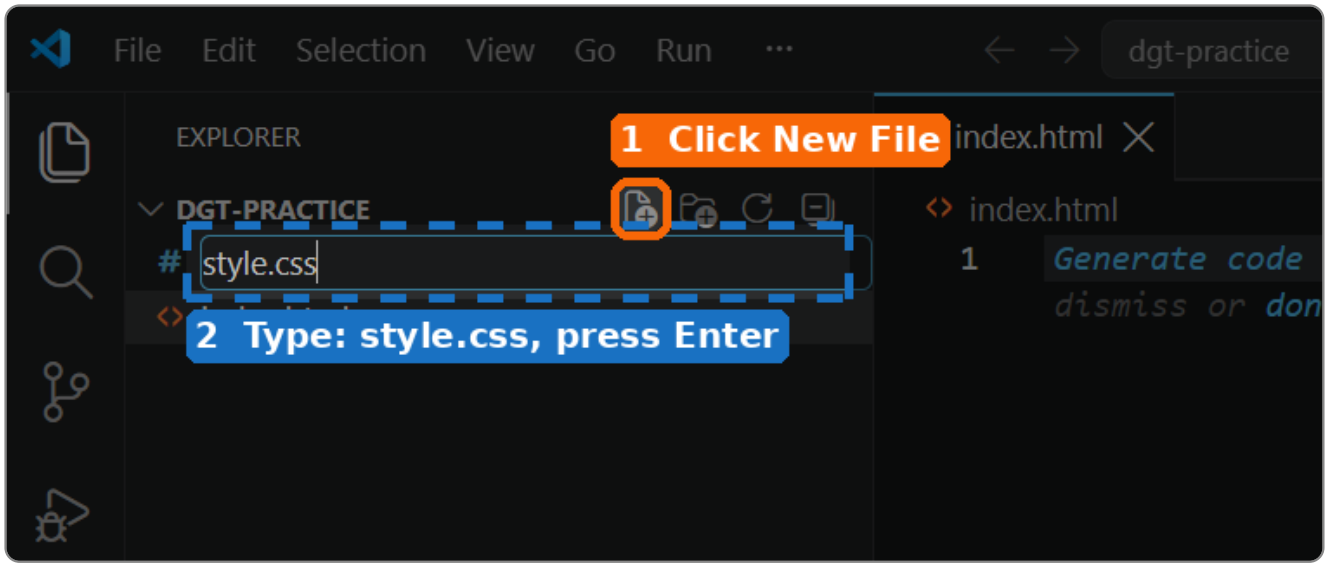
3

VS Code › Explorer

Click the **New File...** icon again.

Type `style.css`.

Press `Enter`.

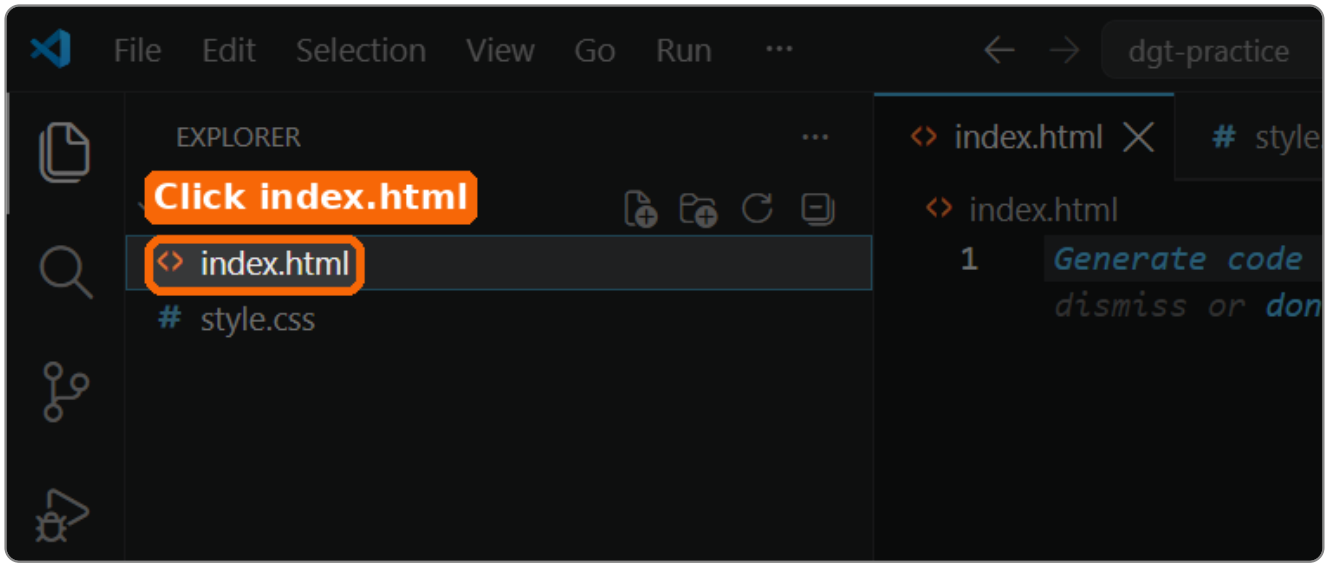


4

VS Code › Explorer

Click `index.html` to open it.

> **Check:** both `index.html` and `style.css` are in the Explorer.



5

VS Code › index.html

Type `!` (an exclamation mark).

When a list shows **! Emmet Abbreviation**, press `Tab`.

If something goes wrong
No list appears: press `Ctrl+Space`. Check the file name ends in `.html`.



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VS Code › index.html

Look at the starting code VS Code wrote for you.

Every web page needs this. You'll learn what each line does as you go.

> **Check:** the code runs from `<!DOCTYPE html>` to `</html>`.

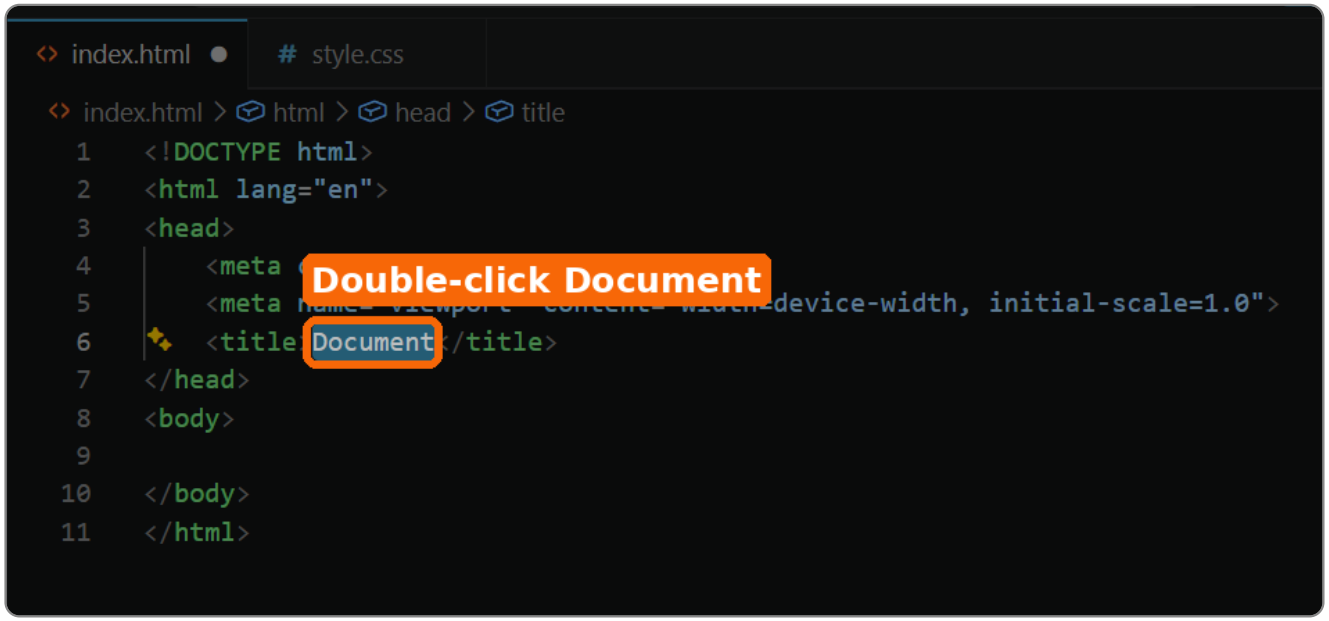


7

VS Code › index.html

In the `<title>` line, double-click `Document`.

> **Check:** `Document` is highlighted.

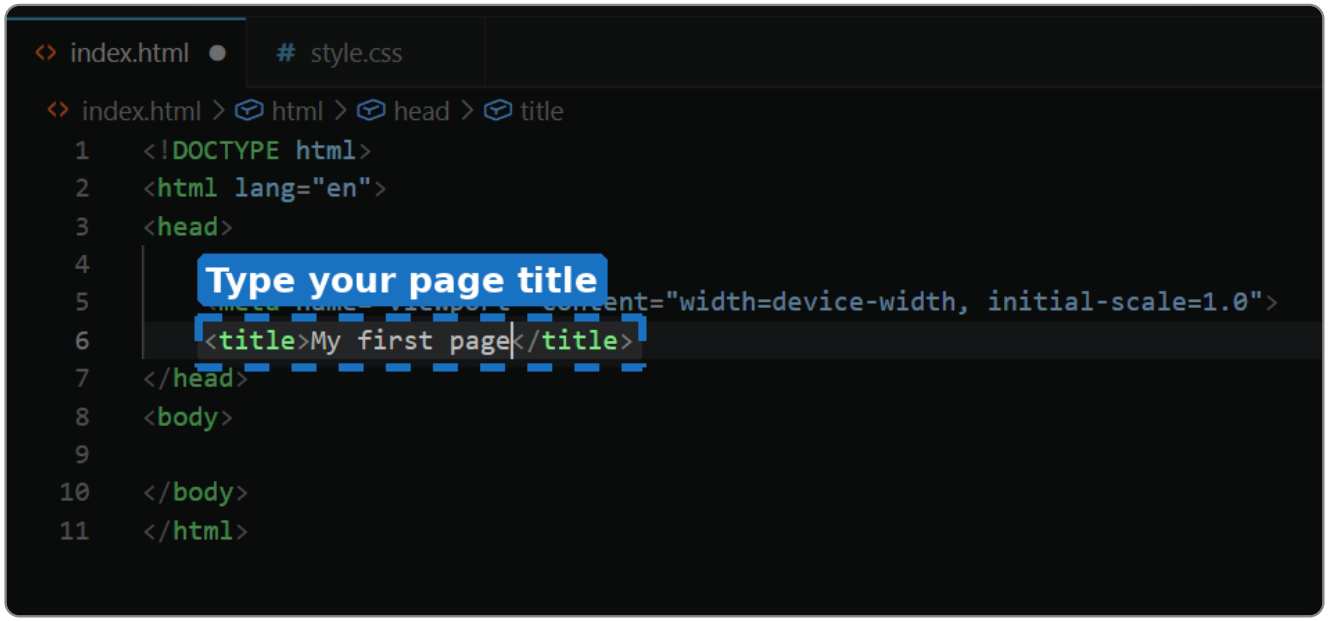


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VS Code › index.html

Type your page title, for example `My first page`.

The title shows on the browser tab.



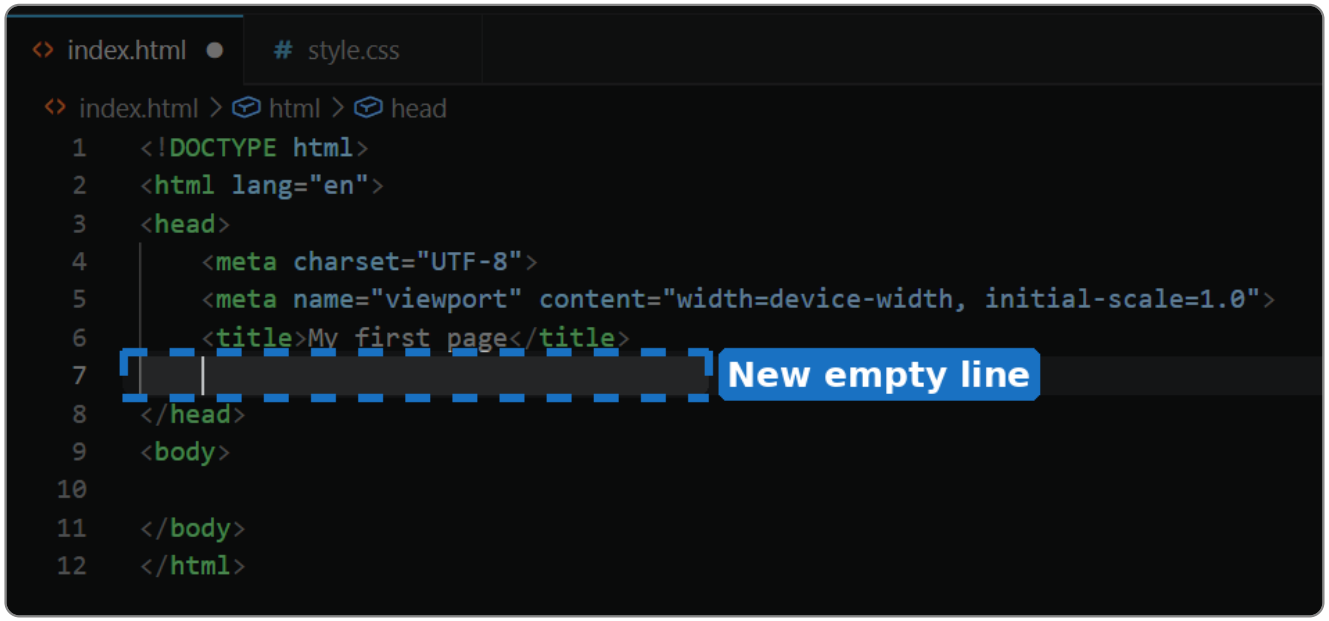
9

VS Code › index.html

Click at the end of the `<title>` line.

Press Enter.

> **Check:** the cursor is on a new empty line, still inside the head.



10

VS Code › index.html

Type `link:css`.

When a list shows **link:css**, press Tab.



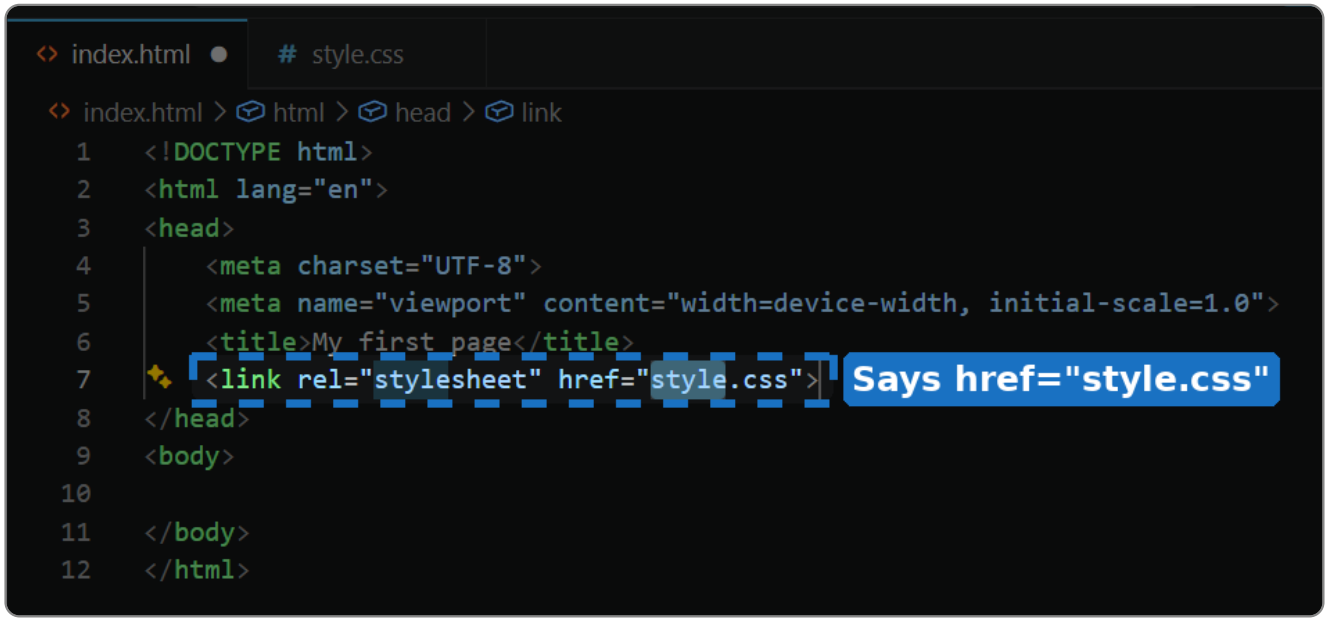
11

VS Code › index.html

Look at the new line.

VS Code highlights `style`. Don't type yet, or you'll replace it.

> **Check:** a new `<link>` line ends with `href="style.css"`. It links your page to your CSS file.



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VS Code › index.html

Click on the empty line between `<body>` and `</body>`.

Type `<h1>Kia ora</h1>`.

VS Code adds the closing tag for you. Just type the words inside.

> **Check:** a white dot on the tab means the file isn't saved yet.



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VS Code › index.html

Press `Ctrl+S` to save.

> **Check:** the white dot on the tab changes back to an X.

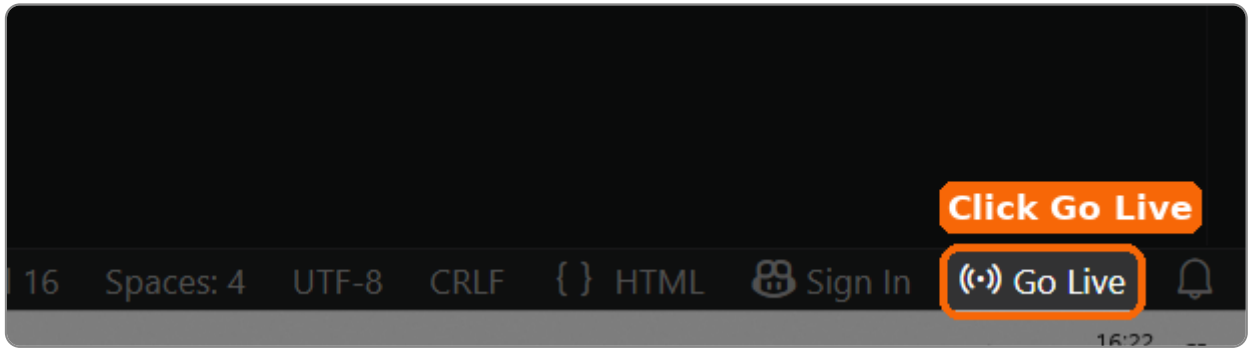


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VS Code › Status bar

Click **Go Live** at the bottom right of VS Code.

If something goes wrong
No Go Live: install Live Server (see the guide Install VS Code extensions).



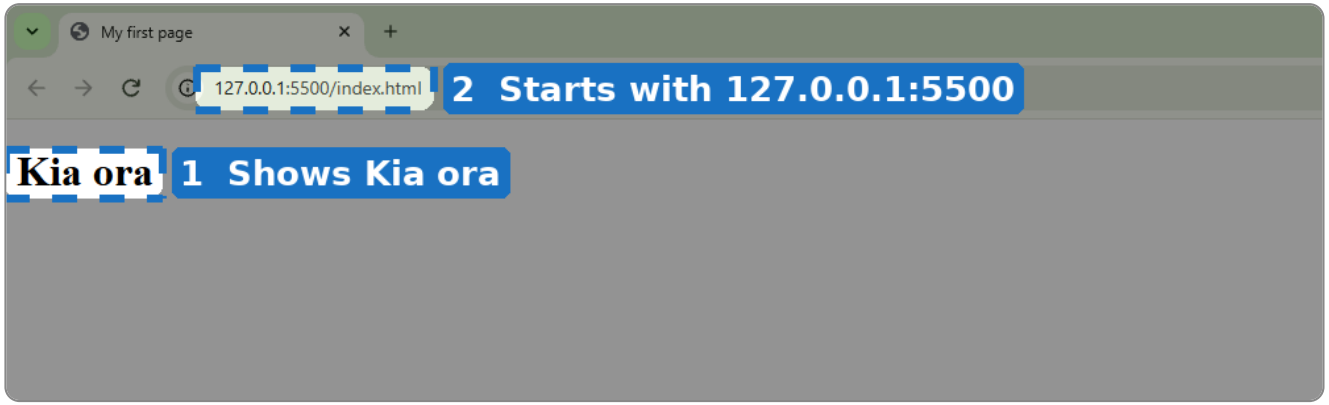
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Chrome

Look at your page.

Live Server opens your page in your default browser.

> **Check:** you see **Kia ora**, and the address starts with `127.0.0.1:5500`.



Save, then look
Every time you press `Ctrl+S`, your page in the browser updates by itself.

Next lesson
Open your folder, open `index.html`, and click **Go Live** again. While it's running, **Go Live** shows **Port : 5500** instead.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I made `index.html` and `style.css`.
- [ ] I used `!` and `link:css` with `Tab`.
- [ ] I saved and previewed my page with **Go Live**.

